



Lab Title: Xampp Installation on Kali Linux

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Course Name: BVWS103 – Owasp Top 10 Vulnerabilities
Exploitation Techniques

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Date of Submission: 22/1/2026

Executive Summary

This lab focused on setting up a local web application testing environment by installing **XAMPP on Kali Linux**. XAMPP provides an integrated stack consisting of Apache, MySQL, and PHP, which enables the hosting and testing of web applications in a controlled environment. Successful completion of the lab ensures that the system is properly configured for subsequent hands-on web application security testing and vulnerability exploitation exercises.

Lab Objectives

The objective of this lab was to install and configure **XAMPP on Kali Linux** in order to establish a functional local web server environment. This setup is required for hosting vulnerable web applications and performing practical security testing throughout the course.

Lab Environment

The lab was conducted using the following environment:

- **Operating System:** Kali Linux (physical machine or virtual machine)
- **Web Server Stack:** XAMPP (Apache, MySQL, PHP)
- **Hardware Platform:** Virtualized or physical system
- **Network Requirement:** Internet access for downloading XAMPP

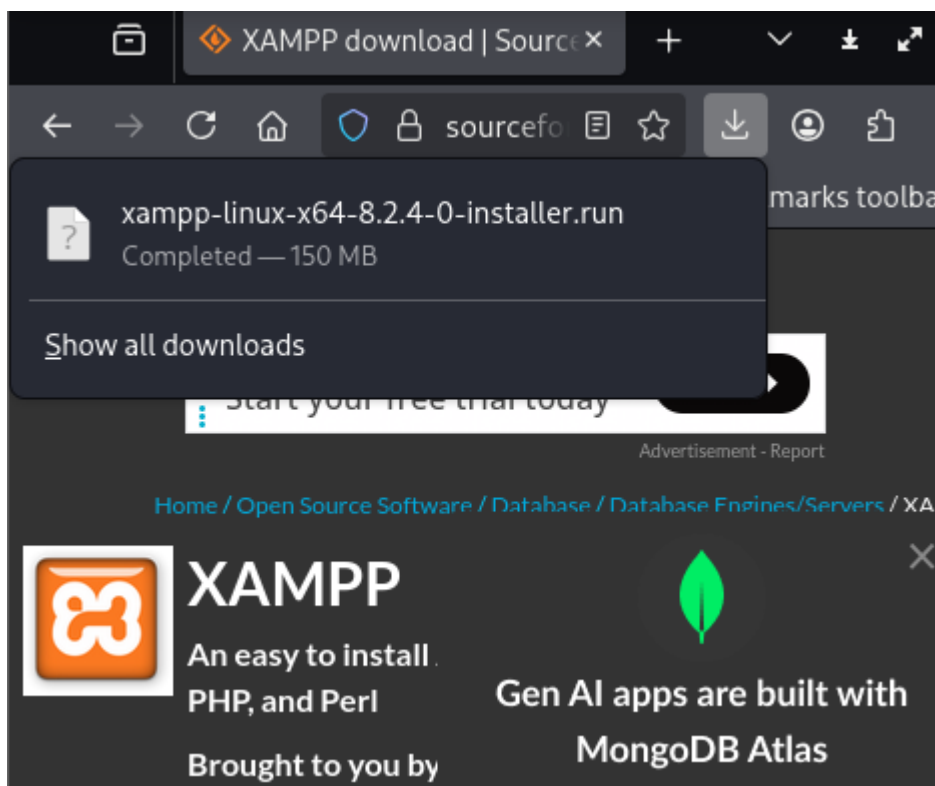
Methodology

The lab was completed using the following approach:

1. Updated Kali Linux package repositories to ensure system stability.

```
(raph@kali)-[~]
$ sudo apt update
[sudo] password for raph:
Get:1 http://kali.download/kali kali-rolling InRelease [34.0 kB]
Get:2 http://kali.download/kali kali-rolling/main amd64 Packages [20.7 MB]
Get:3 http://kali.download/kali kali-rolling/main amd64 Contents (deb) [52.2 MB]
Get:3 http://kali.download/kali kali-rolling/main amd64 Contents (deb) [52.2 MB]
Get:3 http://kali.download/kali kali-rolling/main amd64 Contents (deb) [52.2 MB]
Get:6 http://kali.download/kali kali-rolling/contrib amd64 Packages [116 kB]
Get:7 http://kali.download/kali kali-rolling/contrib amd64 Contents (deb) [268 kB]
Fetched 73.3 MB in 2min 54s (421 kB/s)
2533 packages can be upgraded. Run 'apt list --upgradable' to see them.
```

2. Downloaded the official XAMPP installer for Linux.



3. Modified file permissions to allow execution of the installer.

```
(raph@kali)~$ cd Downloads
(raph@kali)~$ ls
file
metasploitable-linux-2.0.0.zip
node-v24.11.1-linux-x64
node-v24.11.1-linux-x64.tar.xz
xampp-linux-x64-8.1.25-0-installer.run
xampp-linux-x64-8.2.4-0-installer.run

(raph@kali)~$ chmod +x xampp-linux-x64-8.0.30-0-installer.run
chmod: cannot access 'xampp-linux-x64-8.0.30-0-installer.run': No such file or directory

(raph@kali)~$ chmod +x xampp-linux-x64-8.2.4-0-installer.run

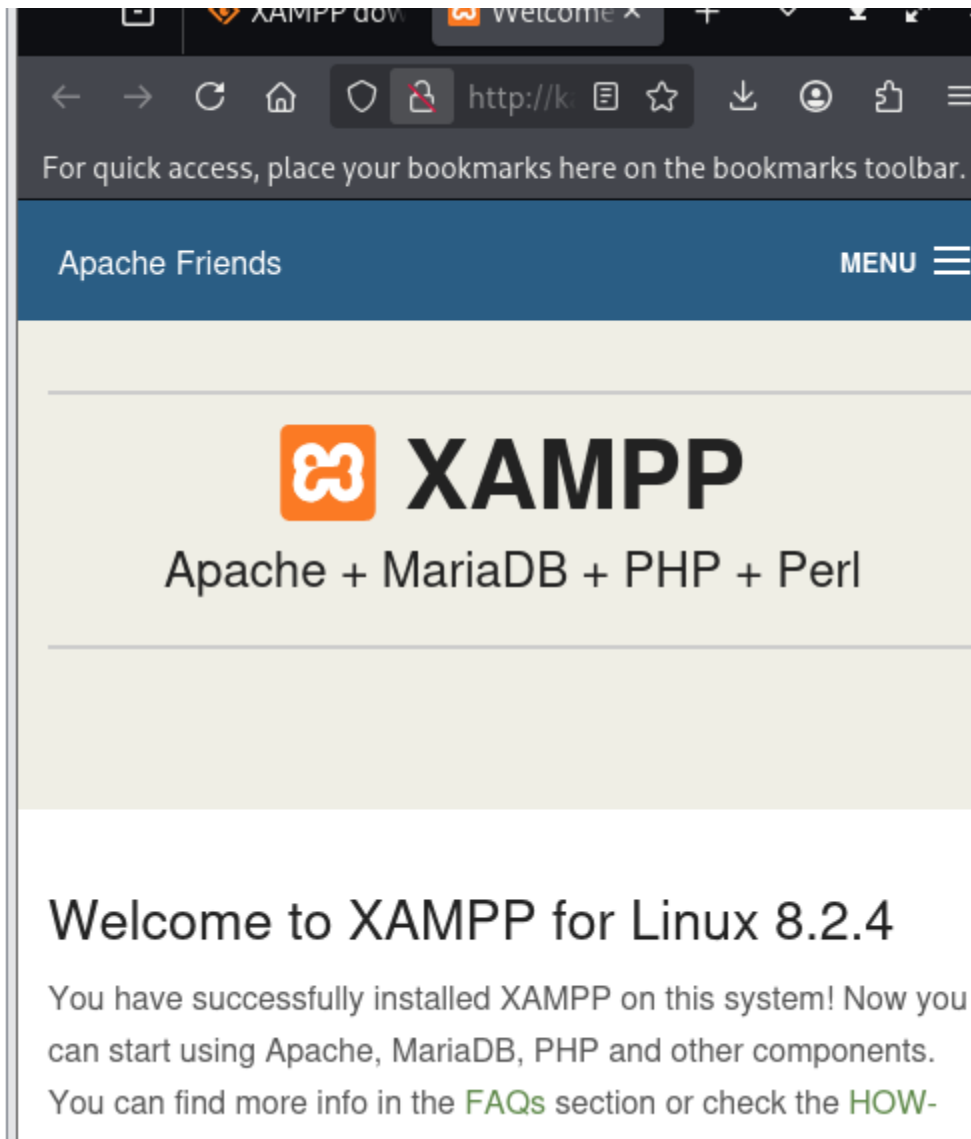
(raph@kali)~$
```

4. Installed XAMPP using the graphical installation wizard.

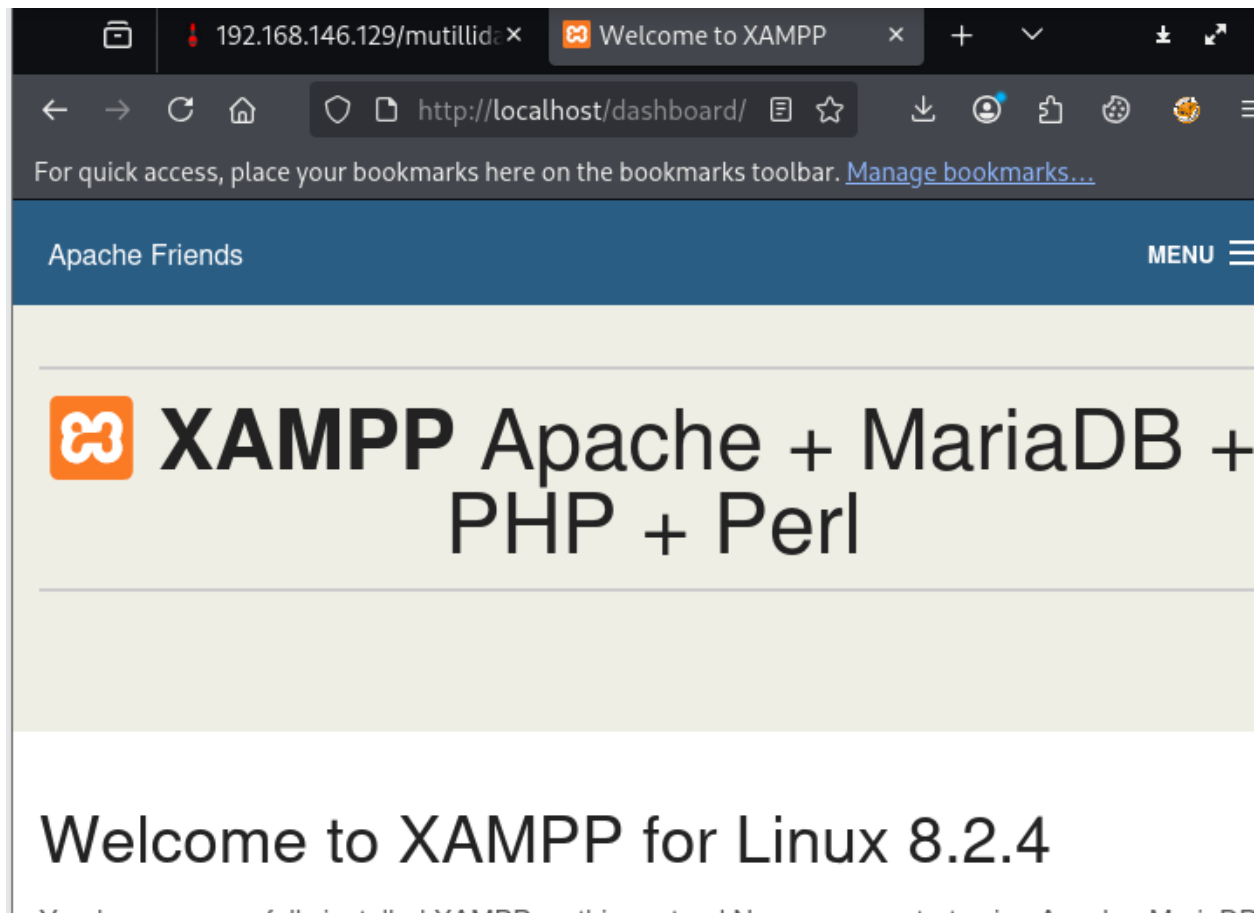
```
(raph@kali)~$ chmod +x xampp-linux-x64-8.2.4-0-installer.run
(raph@kali)~$ sudo ./xampp-linux-x64-8.2.4-0-installer.run
[sudo] password for raph:
sudo: ./xampp-linux-x64-8.2.4-0-installer.run: command not found

(raph@kali)~$ sudo ./xampp-linux-x64-8.2.4-0-installer.run
(raph@kali)~$
```

5. Started XAMPP services and verified successful operation.



6. Tested Apache and PHP functionality by accessing the local web server through a browser.



7. Applied basic security configurations and validated PHP support.

```
(raph@kali)-[~]
$ sudo /opt/lampp/xampp security
XAMPP: Quick security check...
XAMPP: MySQL is accessible via network.
XAMPP: Normaly that's not recommended. Do you want me to turn it of
f? [yes] y
XAMPP: Turned off.
XAMPP: MySQL has to run before I can check the security.
XAMPP: MySQL has to run before I can check the security.
XAMPP: MySQL has a root passwort set. Fine! :)
XAMPP: The FTP password for user 'daemon' is still set to 'xampp'.
XAMPP: Do you want to change the password? [yes] yes
XAMPP: Password:
XAMPP: Password (again):
XAMPP: Reload ProFTPD...not running.
XAMPP: Done.
```

Test Php Support

```
(raph@kali)-[~]
$ cd /opt/lampp/htdocs

(raph@kali)-[/opt/lampp/htdocs]
$ sudo nano test.php

(raph@kali)-[/opt/lampp/htdocs]
$ sudo nano test.php

(raph@kali)-[/opt/lampp/htdocs]
$
```

```
raph@kali: /opt/lampp/ht
Session Actions Edit View Help
GNU nano 8.6 test.ph
<?php
phpinfo();
?>
```

ERROR: ...

localhost/test.php

For quick access, place your bookmarks here on the bookmarks toolbar. [Manage](#)

PHP Version 8.2.4

System	Linux kali 6.16.8+kali-amd64 #1 SMP
Build Date	Apr 6 2023 08:18:17
Build System	Linux b2d8854a0cf5 5.15.49-linuxkit #
Configure Command	./configure' '--prefix=/opt/lampp' '--w '--with-mysql=mysqlnd' '--enable-inlin '--enable-ctype' '--enable-ftp' '--enable sigchild' '--enable-sysvsem' '--enable-s opt/lampp' '--with-png-dir=/opt/lamp lampp' '--with-openssl=/opt/lampp' '--

This structured process ensured that the XAMPP environment was correctly installed, operational, and ready for future web application security labs.

Conclusion

In this lab, I successfully installed and configured XAMPP on Kali Linux, which helped me understand how a local web server environment works. I learned how Apache, MySQL, and PHP work together to host and run web applications. I also gained hands-on experience starting and managing services, troubleshooting common issues like server connection errors, and verifying web applications using the browser.

This lab is important because it prepared me to host vulnerable web applications for security testing. The knowledge gained will help me troubleshoot web server issues, understand how attacks target web applications, and apply practical solutions when problems occur in real-world environments. Overall, this lab improved my confidence in setting up and managing web application testing environments.